

RAYEN GHALI

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EDUCATION

University of Moncton, Faculty of Engineering

Master of Applied Science (MASC) | CGPA: 4.15/4.3

Expected Mar 2026

New Brunswick, Canada

University of Carthage, National Institute of Applied Science and Technology (INSAT)

Industrial and Systems Engineering | Graduated with High Honours

Sept 2023

Tunis, Tunisia

PROJECTS

End-to-End Multimodal AI Agent for Autonomous Robotic Control

Master's Thesis

- Designed an LLM-based agent integrated with a Vision-Language-Action (VLA) policy for end-to-end robotic control, enabling autonomous task planning, error recovery, and real-time action execution from visual observations
- Applied parameter-efficient fine-tuning and reinforcement learning to adapt vision-language models for robotic action generation
- Established evaluation benchmarks measuring success rates, latency, and reliability across VLA architectures on real-world manipulation tasks and simulation environments
- Orchestrated distributed multi-GPU training on Compute Canada's CCDB cluster via Slurm, using W&B for experiment tracking and reproducibility

ChunkCanvas

- Built a full-stack document-processing application for RAG workflows, supporting multimodal parsing of PDFs, images, and audio/video using vLLM for local model serving alongside cloud inference engines, LangChain-based chunking, embedding generation, and vector database ingestion

EXPERIENCE

Applied AI Research Assistant

LARIHS, University of Moncton

Apr 2023 – Present

New Brunswick, Canada

LLM-Driven Industrial Robot Control

- Engineered a multimodal agent using LangGraph to control an industrial KUKA robot via natural language (text and speech)
- Integrated persistent conversational memory and a toolset for pick-and-place, Cartesian, and joint space movements, achieving <2.6s end-to-end latency
- Implemented a robust error recovery system featuring safety checks, rollback, automatic retries, and real-time voice feedback
- Co-authored "LLM-driven agent for speech-enabled control of industrial robots: A case study in snow-crab quality inspection," published in *Results in Engineering*, 2025

Survey Data Analytics Platform

- Migrated 15 years of Acadian student survey data from 7 schools, converting Excel files to a centralized PostgreSQL database
- Built a multi-agent workflow using LangGraph with human-in-the-loop validation for natural language queries
- Developed a Streamlit web application with automated plotting for query results (chatcapitalhumain.ca); validated with research personnel and adopted to streamline survey data analysis

Genealogical RAG Conversational Agent

- Developed a RAG-based conversational agent for querying historical Acadian genealogical records (1700-1900), reducing average archivist search time from ~15 minutes per query to under 30 seconds (chatacadien.ca)
- Engineered entity-centric chunking and context grounding solutions to disambiguate individuals with identical names in unstructured genealogical text, mitigating a primary cause of model hallucinations
- Evaluated and validated the system for faithfulness, context precision, and recall on a curated dataset of real user interactions
- Built complementary web application for archival image search with VLM-generated descriptions (chatpatrimoineacadien.ca)

Industrial Defect Detection & Few-Shot Learning

- Benchmarked modern object detection models on industrial surface-defect datasets, evaluating accuracy and speed tradeoffs
- Developed SSL-YOLO, a few-shot learning framework combining contrastive self-supervised pre-training with YOLOv8
- Co-authored and presented "Real-time defect detection systems for steel and wood inspection" (IEEE CECCE 2024) and "Benchmarking few-shot learning techniques for steel surface defect detection" (IEEE SWC 2025)

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL

Technologies: PyTorch, Transformers, LangChain, FastAPI, vLLM, W&B, Supabase, Git, Docker, GCP

LANGUAGES

Arabic: Native | French: Bilingual | English: Proficient